



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: Ah, Tibet! Home of Buddhism!



Learning Outcome

Describe detailed facts about events or actions in work and social contexts, in written or spoken situations.

Ask your partner:

- What do you know about the country of Tibet?
- What do you know about the Dalai Lama and his teachings?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about different cultures, civilizations, and social issues.
- I can emphasize key information in a statement.
- I can say and use words like *photographic* and *dimension*.





Let's Explore!

The **Buddhists*** came to Tibet in the 7th Century.

* "Buddhists" follow the teachings of Buddha.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Located in the southwest section of China, the nation of Tibet is the highest region on Earth, with an elevation that averages over 16,000 feet or 4,875 meters in metric. Because it is so high up, Tibet is sometimes called the "roof of the world."

One of the highest plateaus is a portion of Tibet called the Chang Tang, or northern plateau. This is home to the Changpa nomads, a semi-nomadic Tibetan ethnic group. Here they live their stoic lives, leading their heavy coated goats, sheep, and yaks from pasture to pasture, and singing their traditional music.

Living on the Chang Tang, surviving temperatures that can change by 80 degrees Fahrenheit in one day and that can go as low as minus 40 degrees Fahrenheit in the winter seems to defy logic, but they manage it.

Tibet has a unique and ancient culture that dates back hundreds of years. In the 7th century AD, Buddhists came to Tibet on a mission to spread their religion. They had vision. They had created an alphabet for the Tibetan language, then translated the Buddhist holy books into a Tibetan version. Buddhism thrived.

The entry of Buddhism into Tibet led to the development of Lamaism, Tibet's spiritual movement. The Dalai Lama, the man who leads the movement with passion, is believed to be the reincarnation of the Buddha. When a Dalai Lama dies, his soul is thought to enter the body of a newborn boy who then becomes the next Dalai Lama.





Let's Practice!

It's easy to get emphatic when you talk about Tibet!

Instructions: Read the paragraph. Choose the option that best completes the sentences. Practice reading the paragraph. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Tibet is the highest region on **Earth / Asia** . Because it is so high up, Tibet is sometimes called the "**roof of the world**" / "**a spiritual movement**" . Tibet has a unique and **ancient culture / alphabet culture** that dates back hundreds of years. The entry of Buddhism into Tibet led to the development of **Buddhists / Lamaism** . The Dalai Lama, the man is believed to be the 5th **reincarnation / mission** of the Buddha.



Let's Practice!

It's easy to get enthusiastic about the Tibetan nation!

Instructions: Read the paragraph. Complete the gaps with the words from the word bank. There are three options you do not need to use.

Work Bank

mission / ethics / version / historic / semi-nomadic / nation / stoic / vision / section

1. Located in the southwest _____ of China, the _____ of Tibet is the highest region on Earth.
2. Here they live their _____ lives.
3. The Changpa nomads are a _____ Tibetan ethnic group.
4. They translated the Buddhist holy books into a Tibetan _____.
5. Buddhists came on a _____ to spread their religion.





Extension Activity

Listen to the Dalai Lama speak.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online or to the library and find a video with the Dalai Lama speaking.
- Take notes on what he says about life and Buddhism.
- Write down any new vocabulary words you hear so you can look them up and then listen again.
- Summarize what the Dalai Lama has said.
- Read your summary to a partner or group.
- Discuss what the Dalai Lama has said and what it means to you.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I find a video with the Dalai Lama speaking.

☐ ☐

I take notes on what he says about life and Buddhism.

☐ ☐

I write down and look up any new vocabulary words.

☐ ☐

I summarize what the Dalai Lama has said.

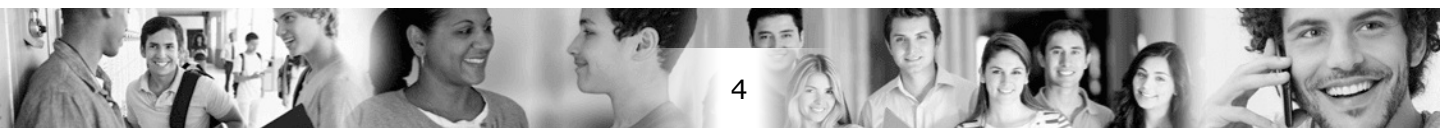
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I discuss what the Dalai Lama has said.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- soul** (noun): the spiritual part of a person
e.g. When a Dalai Lama dies, his soul is thought to enter the body of a newborn boy who then becomes the next Dalai Lama.
- elevation** (noun): how high up something is
e.g. Tibet is the highest region on Earth, with an elevation that averages over 16,000 feet or 4,875 m in metric.
- roof of the world** (expression): the highest point on earth
e.g. Tibet is sometimes called the "roof of the world".
- semi-nomadic** (noun): traveling from place to place for part of the year
e.g. This is home to the Changpa nomads, a semi-nomadic Tibetan ethnic group.
- plateau** (noun): a high flat area of land
e.g. One of the highest plateaus in a portion of Tibet called the Chang Tang, or northern plateau.
- ethnic** (adjective): relating to a particular race of people
e.g. This is home to the Changpa nomads, a semi-nomadic Tibetan ethnic group.
- stoic** (adjective): determined and uncomplaining
e.g. Here they live their stoic lives.
- pasture** (noun): where animals graze
e.g. They lead their heavy coated goats, sheep, and yaks from pasture to pasture.
- mission** (noun): an important job
e.g. In the 7th century AD, Buddhists came to Tibet on a mission to spread their religion.





Learning Points

Emphatic Stress

Stress and intonation are important parts of both listening and speaking in English. There are four different types of stress. Let's focus on emphatic stress.

When you emphasize a word or an idea, you change the stress in the sentence from the main noun to another **content word** like an adjective (high, small) or adverb (extremely, very).

This emphasis focuses the listener's attention to a quality of the thing or idea you want to emphasize.

For example:

*That was a hard **question**.* - Standard statement.

*That was a **hard** question.* - Emphasizes how hard the question was.

It is common to use emphatic stress with adverbs like:

*extremely
terribly
completely
utterly
especially*

For example:

*That was an **extremely** hard question.*

Remember, when you stress a word, your intonation **rises** and the word is said slightly longer and louder than the other words.

Practice reading these sentences from the text:

Examples:

- Tibet is the **highest** region on Earth, with an **elevation** that averages over 16,000 feet or 4,875 meters in metric. Because it is **so** high up, Tibet is sometimes called the "**roof of the world**".
- Tibet has a **unique** and **ancient** culture that dates back hundreds of years.
- The **entry** of Buddhism into Tibet led to the **development** of Lamaism.
- The Dalai Lama, the man is believed to be the **reincarnation** of the Buddha.
- When a Dalai Lama dies, his **soul** is thought to enter the body of a **newborn boy** who then becomes the **next** Dalai Lama.





Learning Points

Stress with Suffixes: One Syllable Before the Suffix

Often, it seems that the stress you place on certain syllables appears to not follow any pattern.

However, when you look at words in reverse, from the end of the word toward the front, a pattern emerges.

These patterns can help you become familiar with how certain words are pronounced.

For example, the words *economic*, *specific*, and *classic* include the suffix *-ic*. You stress the third, second and first syllables respectively. The pattern can only be found when it is understood that syllables must be counted from the end of the word toward the beginning of the word. In fact, the words *economic*, *specific*, and *classic* follow the same pattern of being stressed on the syllable before the *-ic* suffix.

Let's look at the words *economic*, *specific* and *classic*. They all end in the suffix *-ic*. When you read them aloud, they do not necessarily follow a pattern. But, try looking at them in reverse. You will notice a pattern.

Three syllables before the suffix	Two syllables before the suffix	One syllable before the suffix	<i>-ic</i>
		class	ic
	spe	ci	fic
e	co	no	mic

The pattern with these kinds of words, is that they are stressed on the first syllable before the suffix.

Other suffixes which follow this rule are:

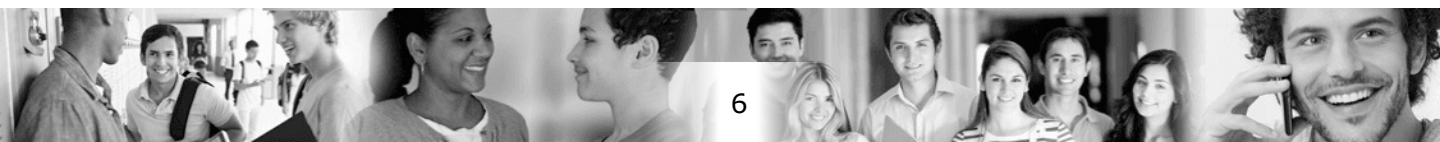
-tion

-sion

For example:

nation

vision





Learning Points

Try reading these sentences from the text. Focus on saying the words with these suffixes correctly:

Examples:

- Located in the southwest **section** of China, the **nation** of Tibet is the highest region on Earth.
- The **elevation** that averages over 16,000 feet or 4,875 meters in **metric**.
- One of the highest plateaus in a **portion** of Tibet called the Chang Tang.
- The Changpa nomads are a **semi-nomadic ethnic** group.
- Here they live their **stoic** lives.
- They sing **traditional** music.
- Surviving temperatures that can change by 80 degrees Fahrenheit in one day seems to defy **logic**.
- Buddhists came on a mission to spread their **religion**.
- They had **vision**.
- They translated the Buddhist holy books into a Tibetan **version**.
- The Dalai Lama, the man who leads the movement with **passion**.

